

Building Your CS Career Toolkit with AI:

A Practical Guide for Customer Success Professionals

Created by Joshua J. Lyons | [linkedin.com/in/joshualyons](https://www.linkedin.com/in/joshualyons) | May 2026

Table of Contents

1. Overview — What This Is and Why It Matters
2. Why Claude (vs. Other AI Tools)
3. What You Need to Get Started
4. Before You Build Anything — Think These Through First
5. The Skills System — What It Is and How It Works
6. Recommended Skills — What to Build and In What Order
7. Setting Up Your Claude Project
8. How to Use Claude Day-to-Day
9. Important Considerations and What to Customize

1. Overview — What This Is and Why It Matters

This guide walks you through how I used Claude — Anthropic's AI — to build a complete, personalized job search system for Customer Success professionals. The result is a set of interconnected "skills" (structured instruction documents) that turn Claude into a career assistant that actually knows you — your experience, your voice, your target roles, and your differentiators.

What I built covers the full job search workflow: resume tailoring, cover letter generation, interview prep, job description analysis, LinkedIn profile content, and a personal development roadmap. Once set up, most of these tasks go from hours to minutes.

What makes this different from just using ChatGPT: The system is built around *you specifically* — your metrics, your stories, your voice, your career history. Every output reflects that context automatically. You're not starting from scratch with each conversation.

The core idea: Build once, use repeatedly. The investment is in the setup — building skills that capture who you are professionally. After that, Claude applies that context to every task automatically.

2. Why Claude (vs. Other AI Tools)

You may already use ChatGPT, Gemini, or other AI tools. Here's why Claude is the right choice for this specific use case:

- **Projects with persistent knowledge:** Claude's Project feature lets you upload documents (your skills) that Claude references automatically in every conversation. ChatGPT and Gemini have similar features, but Claude's implementation is particularly well-suited to document-heavy, context-rich workflows.
- **Writing quality:** Claude produces cleaner, more natural prose than most AI tools — especially important for resumes, cover letters, and LinkedIn content where generic AI-speak is a liability.
- **Long context window:** Claude can hold a large amount of context in a single conversation, which matters when you're working through a complex task like resume tailoring or interview prep.
- **Instruction-following:** Claude is particularly good at following detailed, structured instructions — exactly what the skills system relies on.

Note: This guide was built using Claude Sonnet via claude.ai. The Pro subscription (\$20/month) is required for the Project feature and for the higher usage limits you'll need for this kind of work.

3. What You Need to Get Started

- **A Claude account:** Create one at claude.ai using your email address.
- **A Pro subscription:** Required for Projects, higher message limits, and access to more capable models. Currently \$20/month. Worth it.
- **A dedicated Project:** In Claude, a Project is a workspace that holds your skills (uploaded documents) and a system prompt (instructions). Create one Project for your job search and keep everything in it.
- **Your existing resume:** Have a current version ready — even if it needs work. You'll use it as the starting point.
- **Time for setup:** Plan for 3-5 hours across a few sessions to build your skills properly. The quality of your inputs determines the quality of everything Claude produces.

4. Before You Build Anything — Think These Through First

The skills system is only as good as the information you put into it. Before you start building, spend time thinking through the following. Your answers become the raw material for your Profile Skill — the foundation everything else depends on.

Your Professional Identity

- What is the single most distinctive thing about your CS career? What do you do better than most CSMs?
- What are the 3-5 metrics from your career that best represent your performance? (\$, %, timeframes)
- What's the through-line across your roles — the story that connects everything?

Your Target Role

- IC (Sr. CSM) or management, or both? If both, you'll want two versions of your resume.
- What industries are you targeting? What company stages (startup, growth, enterprise)?
- Remote only, hybrid, or open to in-office? What's your geographic range?
- What's your compensation target — base and total comp?

Your Voice and Communication Style

- How would your best customers describe you in one sentence?
- What phrases do you naturally use that feel authentic vs. ones that feel like corporate speak?
- What writing habits do you want Claude to follow or avoid?

Your Stories

- What's your best "save" story — a customer relationship you recovered?
- What's a time you built something from scratch that made CS better?
- What's a difficult conversation you handled well?
- How have you partnered with Sales to drive expansion?

Pro tip: Write your answers in bullet points before you start working with Claude. The more specific and quantified your inputs, the more useful everything Claude produces will be. Vague inputs produce generic outputs.

5. The Skills System — What It Is and How It Works

A "skill" in this context is a structured Markdown document (.md file) that you upload to your Claude Project. Each skill tells Claude something specific about you or instructs Claude to behave in a particular way when working on a specific task.

Claude reads all uploaded skill files at the start of every conversation in the Project. This means Claude automatically knows your background, your voice, your resume content, and your interview stories — without you having to explain any of it each time.

How to upload a skill:

- Go to your Project home page in Claude
- Find the "Files" panel on the right side
- Click the "+" button and upload your .md file
- Name it clearly (e.g., PROFILE_SKILL.md)

The Project Instructions (system prompt) is a short block of text that tells Claude how to use the skills. It goes in the "Instructions" field in your Project settings. Think of it as the master instruction that activates everything else.

6. Recommended Skills — What to Build and In What Order

Build these in order — each one depends on the ones before it.

1. Profile Skill (Build First)

The authoritative source of truth about you. Contains your career history, key metrics, target role criteria, compensation targets, core competencies, and signature narrative themes. Every other skill references this one. If you only build one skill, build this one.

2. Humanizer Skill (Build Second)

Governs how Claude writes on your behalf. Defines your voice fingerprint — how you sound, what phrases to avoid, what writing mechanics to follow. Without this, Claude's outputs will sound like AI-generated content. With it, everything sounds like you. Includes a cliché filter, banned phrase list, and format rules for resumes, cover letters, emails, and LinkedIn content.

3. Resume Skill (Build Third)

Contains your complete master resume content — every role, every bullet, every metric. Includes tailoring rules for different role types, ATS optimization guidance, and version tracking. This is what Claude uses when you ask it to tailor your resume for a specific job description.

4. Interview Prep Skill (Build Fourth)

A bank of SAR (Situation, Action, Result) stories drawn from your actual experience, mapped to the interview questions you'll most commonly face. Includes prep notes for behavioral questions, panel interview tactics, and questions to ask interviewers. The richer your stories, the more useful this skill becomes.

5. Account Turnaround Skill

Codifies your at-risk account recovery methodology — the phases, principles, and decision frameworks you use when an account is in trouble. Useful for interview prep (your signature differentiator) and as an actual working playbook in your next role.

6. AI Differentiator Skill

If you've used AI tools in your CS work, this skill frames that experience for different audiences — technical hiring managers, non-technical VPs, skeptics. Includes talking points, the before/after story for each tool you've built, and what not to say.

7. Job Targeting Skill (Build Before Applying)

Governs how Claude analyzes job descriptions. When you paste a JD, this skill instructs Claude to produce a structured analysis: fit score, gap assessment, ATS keyword gaps, specific resume edit recommendations, and a positioning angle. Makes every application faster and more precise.

Skill	Priority	Time to Build
Profile Skill	Essential	60-90 min
Humanizer Skill	Essential	30-45 min
Resume Skill	Essential	45-60 min
Interview Prep Skill	High	90-120 min
Account Turnaround Skill	High	45-60 min
AI Differentiator Skill	Medium	30-45 min
Job Targeting Skill	High	30 min

7. Setting Up Your Claude Project

Step 1: Create a Claude Project

In Claude, click "Projects" in the left sidebar, then "New Project." Name it something clear like "CS Job Search" and add a short description of its purpose.

Step 2: Set Your Project Instructions

From the Project home page, click the "+" next to "Instructions" on the right panel. This is your system prompt — the master instruction Claude follows in every conversation. Here's an example to adapt:

```
You are my CS career assistant. At the start of every conversation, load
PROFILE_SKILL as your primary source of truth about me. Apply HUMANIZER_SKILL
to all written outputs so everything sounds like me, not like AI. Load
RESUME_SKILL when working on resume tasks, INTERVIEW_PREP_SKILL for interview
preparation, ACCOUNT_TURNAROUND_SKILL for at-risk account questions,
AI_DIFFERENTIATOR_SKILL for AI-related positioning, and JOB_TARGETING_SKILL
when I paste a job description. Never use generic CS language – my voice is
specific, metric-driven, and earned.
```

Step 3: Kick Off the Project with Your Starting Prompt

Once your Project Instructions are set, open a new chat within the Project and use a prompt like this to get Claude oriented and ask the right preliminary questions. Customize the bracketed fields for your own situation:

```
Help me build the best starting skills to set up Claude to help me as a
Customer Success Manager (CSM) job seeker. I'd like to start with a Profile
Skill, a Humanizer Skill, and a Resume Skill. I've attached my current resume.
My LinkedIn profile is [your LinkedIn URL].
```

```
I've worked at [most recent company] as a [title] starting in [start date]
through [end date]. Once the basic skills are created, I want to walk through
my role there – including day-to-day responsibilities, customers I worked with,
core competencies, the metrics I was measured on, my AI experience, and my
technical skill set. This way you can help me update my resume, build my
interviewing narrative, and identify the high-leverage skills I should develop
to be a more effective CSM.
```

```
Act as an expert in how to build Claude, a Customer Success SME, and a skilled
CS hiring manager as you help me with this project. Ask me preliminary
```

questions to make sure you understand what I need and to get the most out of this project.

This prompt sets Claude's role, establishes what you want to build, and asks Claude to gather the right information before producing anything. Claude will ask you a series of targeted questions — answer them as specifically as possible. The quality of the skills Claude builds depends directly on the quality of your answers.

Step 4: Build Your Profile Skill First

Create a Markdown document (.md file) called PROFILE_SKILL.md. Work through it with Claude by answering its questions about your background, metrics, target roles, and stories. Claude will draft the skill; you review and refine it. Then upload it to your Project's Files section.

Step 5: Build Each Remaining Skill in Order

For each skill, tell Claude what you want to build and let it ask you the right questions. Claude will draft the skill document based on your answers. Download each file, review it, make corrections, and upload the final version to Project Knowledge.

Step 6: Update the Instructions as You Add Skills

Each time you add a new skill file to Project Knowledge, update your Project Instructions to reference it. The instructions tell Claude which files to use and when.

Step 7: Build Your Resume

Once your first three skills are in place, ask Claude to generate your resume as a .docx file. Review it, request edits, and generate both a human-formatted version and an ATS-optimized version. Save both.

Important: Every time you update a skill file, delete the old version from Project Knowledge and upload the new one. Claude reads what's there — outdated files produce outdated outputs.

8. How to Use Claude Day-to-Day

Analyzing a Job Description

Paste the full job description text into a new chat in your Project and say: "Analyze this JD." Claude will produce a structured analysis including fit score, qualitative summary, gap assessment (hard gaps, soft gaps, non-issues), ATS keyword gaps, and a positioning angle. Review the keyword gaps before asking Claude to map them into your resume.

Tailoring Your Resume

After reviewing the JD analysis, tell Claude which keywords to add and ask it to show you specific bullet edits (old vs. new with rationale). Approve the changes, then ask Claude to generate a tailored resume PDF. Keep the tailored version separate from your master resume.

Generating a Cover Letter

Share the JD and say: "Write me a cover letter for this role using the IC template" (or management template). Claude will fill in the role-specific details automatically. Review it, request any changes, and ask for a PDF when ready.

Interview Prep

Tell Claude the company and role you're interviewing for and ask: "Help me prep for this interview." Claude will identify which SAR stories to lead with, suggest how to frame your background for this specific company, and run mock interview questions if you want them. You can also ask Claude to coach a specific answer: "Here's how I answered this question — how do I make it stronger?"

LinkedIn Content

Ask Claude to update specific sections of your LinkedIn profile (About, experience entries, headline) using your profile skill as the source of truth. Claude can also draft posts about your job search, your AI work, or CS topics — always in your voice.

Best practice: Start a new conversation for each distinct task. Long conversations can cause Claude to lose track of early instructions. For complex tasks (full resume tailoring, LinkedIn overhaul), do them in dedicated sessions.

9. Important Considerations and What to Customize

Customize the Profile Skill Thoroughly

The Profile Skill is the most important document in the system. Don't rush it. The more specific your metrics, stories, and target role criteria, the better everything downstream will be. If your Profile Skill is vague, everything Claude produces will be vague.

Tailor the Humanizer Skill to Your Voice

The Humanizer Skill comes with a set of writing rules and a cliché filter. Review every item and remove or adjust anything that doesn't fit how you actually communicate. Add phrases you naturally use. Add phrases you want to avoid. This is the skill that makes outputs sound like you rather than like a resume writer.

If You're Targeting Both IC and Management Roles

Build two versions of your resume — one for IC (Sr. CSM) roles and one for management (Manager/Director) roles. The content overlaps significantly but the framing is different: IC resumes lead with individual results; management resumes lead with team-building, people development, and organizational impact. Your Resume Skill should document both versions and when to use each.

Build Two Resume Versions for ATS

For every resume version, maintain a human-formatted version (colors, design, hyperlinks — for sending directly to people) and an ATS-optimized version (plain black text, no formatting tricks, location included — for uploading to application portals). They should have identical content; only the formatting differs.

The Interview Prep Skill Gets Better Over Time

Start with your 5-7 strongest stories. As you go through actual interviews, add new stories, refine existing ones, and note which questions came up most often. The skill compounds in value the more you use it.

Keep Your Skills Current

Update your Profile Skill whenever something significant changes: new role, new metrics, new target companies, compensation adjustment. Outdated skills produce outdated outputs — and in a job search, outdated means wrong.

Privacy

Your skills contain detailed personal and professional information. Claude.ai's data practices apply — review Anthropic's privacy policy if you have concerns. Avoid uploading anything you wouldn't want stored on a third-party server (e.g., SSNs, confidential employer information).

AI Is a Tool, Not a Shortcut

Everything Claude produces needs your review. Claude will occasionally get something wrong, overstate something, or miss nuance that only you can catch. The system saves time — it doesn't eliminate judgment. Read every output before you use it.